MAKI Cheat Sheet

Media Asset Keeper & Indexer — v4.3.19

Global Options

`--json`	JSON output to stdout
`-v, --verbose`	Show operational details
`-l, --log`	Per-file progress to stderr
`-d, --debug`	External tool debug output
`-t, --time`	Show elapsed time

Setup

maki init
Create a new catalog in the current directory.

maki volume add *[LABEL] PATH*
Register a storage volume (label auto-derived from path if omitted).
`--purpose media|working|archive|backup|cloud`

maki volume list
Show registered volumes with online/offline status.
`--purpose PURPOSE --offline --online`

maki volume set-purpose *LABEL PURPOSE*
Change a volume's logical role.

maki volume remove *LABEL*
Unregister a volume. `--apply`

maki volume combine *SOURCE TARGET*
Merge two volumes. `--apply`

maki volume split *SOURCE LABEL* --path *DIR*
Split subdirectory into new volume. `--apply --purpose`

maki volume rename *VOLUME LABEL*
Rename a volume.

Ingest & Edit

maki import *PATHS...*
Import files into the catalog.
`--volume --profile NAME --auto-group --smart`
`--embed` [Pro] `--describe` [Pro] `--dry-run`
`--include GROUP --skip GROUP`

maki delete *ASSET_IDS...*
Delete assets. `--apply --remove-files`

maki tag *ASSET_ID TAGS...*
Add or remove tags. `--remove`

maki tag rename *OLD NEW*
Rename a tag across all assets. `--apply`
OLD accepts **=** (exact level) and **^** (case-sensitive) prefixes.

maki tag clear *ASSET_ID*
Remove all tags from an asset.

maki tag export-vocabulary
Export tag tree as vocabulary.yaml.
`--prune --default --output FILE`

maki edit *ASSET_ID*
Edit metadata fields.
`--name --description --rating N`
`--label COLOR --date --clear-FIELD`

maki group *HASHES...*
Group variants into one asset.

maki split *ASSET_ID* --variant *HASH*
Split variants out of an asset.

maki auto-group *[QUERY]*
Auto-group by filename stem (directory-local). `--apply --global`

maki describe *[QUERY]* [Pro]
Generate VLM image descriptions.
`--asset ID --volume --model`
`--mode describe|tags|both`
`--apply --force --dry-run`

maki auto-tag *[QUERY]* [Pro]
AI auto-tagging with SigLIP.
`--asset --volume --threshold`
`--labels FILE --apply --download`

maki embed *[QUERY]* [Pro]
Generate image embeddings.
`--asset --volume --force --export`

Organize

maki collection create *NAME*
Create a static album. `--description`

maki collection add *NAME ASSET_IDS...*
Add assets to a collection.

maki collection remove *NAME ASSET_IDS...*
Remove assets from a collection.

maki collection list / show / delete
List, show contents, or delete collections.

maki saved-search save *NAME QUERY*
Save a search query. `--sort --favorite`

maki saved-search list / run / delete
List, run, or delete saved searches.

maki stack create *ASSET_IDS...*
Create a stack. First = pick.

maki stack add *REF ASSET_IDS...*
Add assets to existing stack.

maki stack remove / pick / dissolve / list / show
Stack management commands.

maki stack from-tag *PATTERN*
Convert tag patterns to stacks. `--apply --remove-tags`

maki faces detect / cluster / people / name [Pro]
Face detection and recognition.
`--query --asset --apply --min-confidence`

Retrieve

maki search *QUERY*
Search assets with filters (see back).
`--format ids|short|full|json|{template}`
`-q` (shorthand for **--format ids**)

maki show *ASSET_ID*
Show full asset details.

maki preview *ASSET_ID*
Open preview in OS default image viewer.

maki export *QUERY TARGET*
Export to directory. `--zip --layout flat|mirror`
`--all-variants --sidecars`

maki contact-sheet *QUERY OUTPUT*
Generate PDF contact sheet.
`--layout --paper --landscape`
`--title --fields --sort`

maki duplicates
Find duplicate files. `--mode same|cross --volume --format`

maki stats
Catalog statistics. `--tags --verified`

maki backup-status
Show backup coverage and at-risk assets. `--copies N`

maki doc *[manual|cheatsheet|filters]*
Open documentation PDF in browser.

maki licenses
Show MAKI license + 3rd-party crate licenses. `--summary`

maki serve
Start web UI. `--port --bind`

maki shell
Interactive shell. `-c CMD --script FILE`

Maintain

maki verify *[PATHS...]*
Check file integrity.
`--volume --asset --force --max-age DAYS`

maki sync *[PATHS...]*
Sync with disk changes. `--apply --remove-stale`

maki sync-metadata *[QUERY]* [Pro]
Bidirectional XMP sync. `--asset --dry-run`

maki refresh *[PATHS...]*
Re-read changed recipes. `--dry-run --media`
`--reimport` — full re-extract `--exif-only` — EXIF only

maki writeback *[QUERY]* [Pro]
Write pending edits to XMP. `--all --dry-run`

maki cleanup
Remove stale records. `--apply --list --path`

maki dedup
Remove same-volume duplicate file locations. `--apply --prefer`

maki generate-previews *[PATHS...]*
Generate/regenerate previews.
`--force --smart --upgrade`
`--volume --asset --include --skip`

maki create-sidecars *[QUERY]*
Create XMP sidecars for assets without recipes.
`--volume --asset --apply`

maki relocate *[ASSET_IDS...]*
Copy/move files between volumes.
`--target VOLUME --query --remove-source`
`--create-sidecars --dry-run`

maki update-location *HASH OLD NEW*
Update a file's catalog path after it was moved on disk.

maki fix-roles *[QUERY]*
Fix variant roles in RAW+non-RAW groups.

maki fix-dates *[QUERY]*
Re-extract asset dates from EXIF and file timestamps.

maki fix-recipes *[QUERY]*
Re-attach orphaned recipe files to their assets.

maki rebuild-catalog
Rebuild SQLite from YAML sidecars. `--asset ID` (per-asset)

maki migrate
Run database schema migrations.

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Core Concepts

Asset	Logical media item (one photo)
Variant	Concrete file (Original, Alternate, Processed, Export)
Recipe	XMP/processing sidecar (tracked by location)
Volume	Storage device (online/offline detection)
Stack	Collapsed group in browse (own metadata)
Collection	Static album (manual curation)
Saved Search	Dynamic smart album (query re-evaluated)

Key Workflows

Import & Organize

1. `maki init` + `maki volume add`
2. `maki import --smart /path`
3. `maki serve` — browse in web UI
4. Rate, tag, label via UI or CLI
5. `maki auto-tag ""` [Pro]— AI tagging

Maintenance Cycle

1. `maki verify` — check integrity
2. `maki sync` — detect moved/missing
3. `maki sync-metadata` — bidirectional XMP [Pro]
4. `maki cleanup --apply` — remove stale

Backup & Archive

1. `maki volume add Archive /mnt/nas --purpose backup`
2. `maki relocate --target Archive ""` — copy all
3. `maki backup-status` — check coverage
4. `maki dedup --apply` — remove same-volume dups

Export & Deliver

1. `maki export "rating:4+ tag:portfolio" ./out`
2. `maki export "collection:Client" ./out --zip`
3. `maki contact-sheet "rating:5" portfolio.pdf`

Search Filter Syntax

All filters work in CLI `maki search` and web UI search box.

Text & Metadata

`tag:landscape`	Tag match (hierarchical)
`tag:=landscape`	Exact level only (no descendants)
`tag:^Landscape`	Case-sensitive (not "landscape")
`tag:|wed`	Prefix anchor (wedding, wedding-2024, ...)
`-tag:rejected`	Exclude tag
`type:image`	Asset type
`format:nef`	File format
`label:Red`	Color label
`camera:fuji`	Camera (partial)
`lens:56mm`	Lens (partial)
`description:cat`	Description (substring; alias `desc:`)
`person:Alice`	Named person [Pro]
`collection:Fav`	Collection
`path:2026/`	Path prefix (`*` = wildcard)
`id:72a0`	Asset ID prefix
`meta:key=val`	Source metadata

Numeric Filters

All support: `x` (exact), `x+` (min), `x-y` (range), `x,y` (OR)

`rating:3+`	3 stars or more
`rating:3-5`	3 to 5 stars
`rating:2,4`	Exactly 2 or 4
`rating:0`	Unrated ("the rest")
`iso:100-800`	ISO range
`focal:35-70`	Focal length range
`f:1.4-2.8`	Aperture range
`width:4000+`	Min width (px)
`height:2000+`	Min height (px)
`copies:2+`	File copies
`variants:2+`	Variant count
`scattered:2+`	Distinct directories (`/N` depth)
`duration:30+`	Video duration (seconds)
`codec:h264`	Video codec (partial)
`faces:2+`	Face count [Pro]

Date Filters

`date:2026`	Year prefix
`date:2026-03`	Month prefix
`date:2026-03-15`	Exact date
`dateFrom:2026-01`	From (inclusive)
`dateUntil:2026-12`	Until (inclusive)

Status Filters

`orphan:true`	No file locations
`orphan:false`	Has file locations
`missing:true`	Files missing on disk
`stale:30`	Not verified in N days
`stacked:true`	In a stack
`volume:Archive`	On specific volume
`volume:none`	No online volume
`geo:any`	Has GPS data

Pro Filters

`similar:72a0bb4b`	Visual similarity
`min_sim:90`	Similarity threshold
`text:sunset`	Text-to-image search
`embed:none`	No embedding

Combining Filters

`tag:a,b`	a OR b (comma)
`tag:a tag:b`	a AND b (repeat)
`-tag:x`	NOT (dash prefix)

Output Formats

`maki search --format` *`PRESET|TEMPLATE`*

`ids`	One UUID per line
`short`	ID, name, type, format, date
`full`	+ tags, description, rating
`json`	JSON array
`'{id}\t{name}'`	Custom template

Placeholders: `{id}`, `{name}`, `{filename}`, `{type}`, `{format}`, `{tags}`, `{description}`, `{rating}`, `{label}`, `{date}`, `{size}`

Configuration (maki.toml)

`[preview]`	max_edge, format, quality, smart_max_edge
`[serve]`	port, bind, per_page
`[import]`	exclude, auto_tags, smart_previews, profiles
`[browse]`	default_filter
`[cli]`	log, time, verbose (default global flags)
`[writeback]`	enabled (default: false) [Pro]
`[group]`	session_root_pattern (auto-group scope)
`[dedup]`	prefer
`[verify]`	max_age_days
`[ai]`	model, threshold, labels [Pro]
`[vlm]`	endpoint, model, timeout [Pro]
`[contact_sheet]`	layout, paper, fields

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https://maki-dam.com/